

Pyung Kim

Postdoctoral Scholar

Center for Spatial Studies and Data Science
University of California, Santa Barbara
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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Scholar	2026 – Present
<i>Center for Spatial Studies and Data Science, University of California, Santa Barbara</i>	

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Research Affiliate	2024 – 2025
<i>Spatial Health AI Research Partnership (SHARP), The University of Texas at Dallas</i>	
Instructor	2023 – 2025
<i>Korea Social Science Data Archive (KOSSDA), Seoul National University</i>	
Research Assistant	2020
<i>Korea Institute of Public Administration (KIPA)</i>	

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Public Policy and Political Economy	2025
<i>The University of Texas at Dallas (Brian J.L. Berry Scholarship, Highest Honor)</i>	
Dissertation: “Long-Term Effects of Neighborhoods on Educational Attainment by Disability Status”	
M.S. in Geospatial Information Sciences	2025
<i>The University of Texas at Dallas</i>	
M.A. in Public Administration	2020
<i>Yonsei University (Brain Korea 21 PLUS Scholarship, National Research Foundation)</i>	
B.A. in Public Administration	2018
<i>Ajou University (National Excellence Scholarship, Deputy Prime Minister of Korea)</i>	
<i>Julius-Maximilian University of Würzburg, Germany (Exchange Student, 2017)</i>	

RESEARCH AREAS

Substantive	Social Policy, Health Policy, Urban Policy, Neighborhood Effects, Disability
Methodological	GIS, Geo AI, Deep Learning, Quasi-Experimental Design, Causal Inference

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS ^{*} Corresponding author, [†] Student co-author

4. **Kim, P.**, Choi, S.[†], Kim, D., & Lee, C.^{*}. (2026). Bayesian spatio-temporal modeling for policy evaluation: Sensitivity of policy effect estimates in the context of COVID-19 stay-at-home orders. *PLOS ONE*, 21(2), e0339196.
3. **Kim, P.**^{*}, Kim D., Scotch R., Jeong D.[†], & Kowalske K. (2025). Geospatial analysis of community-level social and environmental barriers for adult burn injury survivors in North Texas. *Burns*, 51(5), 107512.
2. Hong, S.^{*}, Jeong, D.[†], & **Kim, P.** (2024). Have offender demographics changed since the COVID-19 Pandemic? Evidence from money mules in South Korea. *Journal of Criminal Justice*, 91, 102156.
1. **Kim, P.** & Bae, H.^{*} (2022). Do firms respond differently to the carbon pricing by industrial sector? How and why? A comparison between manufacturing and electricity generation sectors using firm-level panel data in Korea. *Energy Policy*, 162, 112773.

UNDER REVIEW

- “Are Neighborhood Effects Larger for Children with Disabilities? Evidence from Texas” (sole author, [preprint available at SSRN](#))
- “Growing Up in Disability-Dense School Districts: Long-Term Impacts on Educational Attainment” (sole author, [preprint available at SSRN](#))
- “A Geography of Administrative Burden: Social Security Field Office Accessibility and the Consequences of Closures” (first author, [preprint available at SSRN](#))
- “Does Carbon Pricing Outperform Command-and-Control Regulation? Firm-Level Evidence from Korea’s Dual Regulatory Framework” (sole author, [preprint available at SocArXiv](#))
- “mHealth Intervention Integrating Personal PM2.5 Monitoring and Deep Learning to Reduce Pediatric Asthma Exacerbations: A Pilot Study” (first author, [preprint available at JMIR](#))
- “Spatial Analysis of Preventive Maternal and Child Oral Health Services in Kilifi County, Kenya: Implications for MCH Workforce Training” (first author)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- “Medicaid Expansion and Cancer Outcomes: Heterogeneous Effects by Geographic Access to Oncology Centers” (with Kristine Hahm)
- “Where Does the Evidence Come From? Mapping the Geographic Footprint of Evidence from Federal Clearinghouses” (with Sarah Bardin & Peter Kedron)
- “Spatial Turn in Causal Inference” (with Lixi Xu, Lei Song, & Peter Kedron)

EXTERNAL GRANTS *Non-U.S. awards are reported in USD using award-date exchange rates.*[PI / Co-PI]

1. What Is the Relationship Between Adolescent Neighborhood Environments and Long-Run Labor Market Outcomes for Children with Disabilities? ([#JSIT24-04](#)) 2024 – 2025
 - **PI: Pyung Kim, UTD**
 - *Social Security Administration via Retirement and Disability Research Center at UW-Madison (\$6,000)*

[Key Personnel]

4. Interventional Study to Prevent Exacerbation of Atopic Dermatitis by Exposure to Particulate Matter 2024 – 2026
 - Role: Data Scientist
 - PI: Kangmo Ahn, *Samsung Medical Center*
 - *Korea Disease Control and Prevention Agency (\$629,630)*
3. Geospatial Community Mapping to Assess Social and Environmental Barriers and Facilitators for Burn Survivors ([#90DPBU0006](#)) 2022 – 2026
 - Role: GIS Specialist (2022 – 2025)
 - PI: Karen Kowalske, *UTSW Medical Center*; co-PI: Dohyeong Kim & Richard Scotch, *UTD*
 - *National Institute on Disability, Independent Living, and Rehabilitation Research (\$2,320,495)*
2. The Capacity-Building Project for Primary Healthcare Workforce to Improve Maternal and Child Oral Health in Kilifi County, Kenya 2025 – 2026
 - Role: GIS Specialist ([field study in Kenya](#))
 - PI: Hyewon Lee, *Seoul National University*
 - *Korea International Cooperation Agency (\$440,000)*
1. Spatial Distribution of Natural Radiation in Jeonbuk and Jeonnam Provinces 2023 – 2025
 - Role: GIS Specialist
 - PI: Yeol Rho, *Chonnam National Univ.*; co-PI: Dohyeong Kim, *UTD*
 - *National Institute of Environmental Research of Korea (\$320,000)*

AWARDS AND HONORS[External Awards]

- [JSIT Research Competition Award](#), *Social Security Administration via UW-Madison* 2024
- [Junior Scholar Intensive Training \(JSIT\)](#), *Social Security Administration via UW-Madison* 2024
- President Travel Award for APPAM, *Korean Association for Policy Studies* 2023
- Brain Korea 21 PLUS Scholarship, *National Research Foundation* 2018 – 2020
- The Next Century Humanities Scholarship (National Excellence Scholarship), *awarded by the Deputy Prime Minister; funded by the Korea Student Aid Foundation* 2015 – 2018

[Internal Awards]

GIS Pioneer Research Scholarship, <i>UT Dallas & Pioneer Natural Resources</i>	2025
Keith Lankford Taylor Fellowship, <i>UT Dallas</i>	2023
Brian J.L. Berry Scholarship (Highest Honor), <i>UT Dallas</i>	2021 – 2025
UT Dallas Graduate Studies Scholarship, <i>UT Dallas</i>	2021 – 2025
YUPA Graduate Studies Scholarship, <i>Yonsei University</i>	2018 – 2020
President's Award for Outstanding Graduate , <i>Ajou University</i>	2018
Teaching Assistantship for Undergraduate Student, <i>Ajou University</i>	2015 – 2016
Excellence in Undergraduate Research Project, <i>Ajou University</i>	2015
Merit-based Full Tuition Scholarship, <i>Ajou University</i>	2014
Dean's list, <i>Ajou University</i>	2014; 2015

MEDIA APPEARANCES

UT Dallas News. (2026). *How Communities Shape Burn Survivors' Return to Society*.
<https://news.utdallas.edu/social-sciences/burn-survivors-societal-reentry-2026/>

INVITED TALKS

“Long-Term Effects of Neighborhoods on Educational Attainment by Disability Status”, <i>Geography Colloquium Lecture, University of California, Santa Barbara</i>	May 2026
“Using GIS to Improve Rural Health Service Planning: Lessons from Kilifi County, Kenya”, <i>Practitioner Seminar, Kilifi Department of Health in Kilifi County, Kenya</i>	Oct 2025

TEACHING

[Instructor]	
Machine Learning and Deep Learning for Social Science (with R) • <i>Korea Social Science Data Archive</i> (graduate) • <i>Rating: 9.64/10</i>	Winter 2026
GIS and Spatial Statistics (with QGIS, GeoDa, and R) • <i>Korea Social Science Data Archive</i> (graduate) • <i>Rating: 9.91/10</i>	Summer 2025
Advanced GIS and Spatial Statistics (with R) • <i>Korea Social Science Data Archive</i> (graduate) • <i>Rating: 9.84/10</i>	Summer 2023
Introductory GIS and Spatial Statistics (with QGIS, GeoDa, and STATA) • <i>Korea Social Science Data Archive</i> (graduate) • <i>Rating: 9.54/10</i>	Summer 2023

[Guest Lecture]

- Quasi-Experimental Mover Designs, Peter Kedron's Lab, *UC Santa Barbara* Feb 2026
- Analysis of Variance, undergraduate statistics course (EPPS 2302), *UT Dallas* April 2025
- Probability Distributions, undergraduate statistics course (EPPS 2302), *UT Dallas* Feb 2025
- Introductory Calculus, graduate statistics course (EPPS 7313), *UT Dallas* Sep 2023

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

* APPAM (Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management); APHA (American Public Health Association); ASPA (American Society for Public Administration); ACRM (American Congress of Rehabilitation Medicine); SER (Society for Epidemiologic Research); ASA (American Sociological Association)

- 2026 APPAM (planned), ASA (planned)
 2025 APPAM, APHA, ASA, SER
 2024 APPAM, ACRM, ASPA
 2023 APPAM, APHA, ASPA

RESTRICTED DATA ACCESS

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2. The Impacts of School Neighborhoods on the Academic and Labor Market Outcomes of Students with Disabilities 2024
- *PI: Pyung Kim*
 - *Student-level longitudinal data (1999 – 2023, $N \geq 10,000,000$)*
 - *Source: Texas Schools Project*
1. Geospatial Community Mapping to Assess Social and Environmental Barriers and Facilitators for Burn Survivors 2022
- *PI: Karen Kowalske, UTSW Medical Center, UTD*
 - *Patient-level longitudinal data (1994 – 2022, $N \geq 25,000$)*
 - *Source: National Institute on Disability, Independent Living, and Rehabilitation Research*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical Analysis (R, STATA)
 Geospatial Analysis (R, Arc GIS, QGIS, GeoDa, Tableau)
 Machine Learning / Deep Learning (R, Python)

SERVICE[Conference Reviewer]

APPAM Fall Research Conference Review 2026

[Peer Reviewer]

Policy Studies Journal (PSJ); International Journal of Finance and Economics; Energy Economics; Energy Policy; Scientific Reports; PLOS ONE

[University Service]

Secretary, <i>Korean Student Association, UT Dallas</i>	2023 – 2024
Vice President, <i>Graduate Student Assembly in Public Administration, Yonsei University</i>	2018 – 2019
Student Mentor, <i>Office of Admissions, Ajou University</i>	2014 – 2015